

potential for 4K UHD TV in the Indian market? The segment is yet to find acceptance in the country. One simple reason is its high-price; 4K TVs in India are priced around Rs 1,600,000.

Howard Lee, director, Home Entertainment, LG India, opines, "Ultra-definition televisions will transform the giant-screen viewing experience in the years ahead, which is why LG has introduced its 213cm (84-inch) UHD 3D TV in the country."

Apart from LG and Sony, brands like Samsung and Panasonic have also shown keen interest in UHD TVs. In fact, Samsung is planning to introduce its products by the end of the year.

The demand is set to grow

The overall picture quality of 4K UHD clearly defines the need to step up the TVs' dimensions to offer better viewing capability. Research has shown that 4K content requires a screen size of at least 213 cm for optimal viewing as UHD makes little difference on displays smaller than 50 (inches).

Sunil Nayyar, head, Sales, Sony India, explains: "With a 102cm (40-inch) 4K television, pixels would be hard to see close-up, and will tend to disappear from about a metre. The average size of TV sets will likely become steadily larger. As this happens, the need for more dots to fill larger screens will grow. 'Standard' HD on a 203cm (80-inch) screen viewed from about three metres away would present a pixelated image."

Considering the high cost of these products, Indian masses surely cannot be their target audience unless the TV makers make some modification. Selling 4K TVs to the commercial market makes more sense to the manufacturers right now. It is believed that initially larger 4K sets are likely to be sold to big companies for their boardrooms and meeting rooms.

Both Sony and LG are keen to tap into the business segment in the country but expect to gradually concentrate on the consumer segment.

"We are looking to strengthen our product offering by introducing Ultra HD displays in different screen sizes. The TVs come equipped with an in-built Ultra HD up-scaler to address the consumer pain point of lack of content," Lee shares.

Another factor that can deter the growth of 4K TVs is the space required by them. If you couple a 213cm (84-inch) UHD TV with the recommended viewing distance of 7 metres, you would find a rather limited market of consumers who have houses large enough to accommodate these space requirements.

TV makers are working on both these aspects. Some online reports claim that at least half of 4K UHD sets may be available for under \$10,000 (approx Rs 530,000). Over subsequent years, the price of 4K TV sets is likely to drop steadily and significantly. With every price decline the accessible market should increase. Within five years, it is likely that smaller 127cm 4K TV sets will sell for under \$1000 (approx. Rs 53,000). The lowering of TV price will be aided by reduction in the TV size, which will translate into less investment on the manufacturing front.

But what about the 4K content for these TVs? Interestingly, Sony and LG are offering their own UHD player with UHD TVs, included in the overall cost of the TV. The player comes loaded with 4K-based movies and video clips.

Yet another concern is the need to adopt high-speed data transfer infrastructure for smooth 4K content delivery. Things on this front will improve with increased broadband connectivity and the availability of 4G bandwidth.

However, 4K UHD is likely to be short-lived as the next upgrade to 4K, i.e., 8K, is already under development.

Nevertheless, the stage is set for 4K TVs in India. It remains to be seen whether companies can cash in on the already created hype or not. ●

The author is a correspondent at EFTimes.com

SHAVISON™

Peripherals for Industrial Automation

SMPS ACCESSORIES

Power Distribution Module

Input: 48VDC max, 20A max
Output: 2 X 12 Way terminals rated for 5A each

Redundancy Module

SMPS 1, SMPS 2

Voltage	Current	Parallel
12VDC	10A	20A
24VDC	5A	10A
48VDC	2.5A	5A

Also Available

- Relay Interface Modules
- SSR Interface Modules
- Opto Interface Modules
- FRC/D-SUB connector
- Diode/Resistor Modules
- Analog Signal Converters
- Dedicated Controllers
- SMPS

SHAVISON™

Website: www.shavison.com
Email: shavison@shavison.com

SHAVISON ELECTRONICS PVT. LTD.

Unit No. G-5, B Wing, Udyog Bhavan No. 2, Plot K-3, Anand Nagar MIDC, Ambarnath (E) 421 506, MH, India.
Tel/Fax: +91-251-2620417/2626427 Cell: +91 98 203 62590

Almadedat: Integrated: 09823438019 Ahmednagar, Tech Edge controls : 09822912595 Akkleshwar / Branch: Ail : 09879061845 Aurangabad: Dadaji Enterprises : 09765117805 Chennai: Shree Krishna Ent : 09840332195 Coimbatore : 09843356059 Delhi : Powertech : 0912260995 Durg (CG) : Aditya : 09827111400 Goa: Kedar : 09850041672 Karnal : Powertech : 0912260995 Kolhapur : Kedar : 09850041672 Madurai: Jaagan Industrial Traders : 09843356284 Mumbai: Lohar Charvi : A. Harlal : 09321066554 Mahavir : 09821022778 Goregaon : Able : 09821522543 Mulund : 09822251679 Andheri : Kishan : 09322231500 Nasik : Nissu : 0942225 Pune : PMP : 09371038510 Silvassa: Vijay : 09824700675 Thane : VE Electronics & Tools : 09819646729 Vasai : Plasmchem : 09371048452

Dealers enquiry solicited